

Team Management Guide

The Cleaning CEO Blueprint — 100% Cleaner Academy

Managing cleaners is where most cleaning companies break — or scale. This guide covers the systems that keep teams accountable, clients happy, and your sanity intact.

The Management Mindset

You are not managing "help." You are leading a **field operations team** that represents your brand inside private homes. Every system below exists to:

1. **Protect clients** — trust, security, consistency
 2. **Protect cleaners** — clear expectations, fair pay, documentation
 3. **Protect you** — liability, quality proof, dispute resolution
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GPS Tracking & Job Verification

Why GPS Matters

- Confirms arrival and departure times
- Resolves "they never showed" disputes
- Identifies chronic lateness patterns
- Supports payroll accuracy for hourly employees

Recommended Tools

Tool	Best For	Notes
Jobber	Scheduling + GPS	Popular with home service
Housecall Pro	All-in-one field service	Strong mobile app
Connecteam	Team communication + GPS	Budget-friendly
Google Maps Timeline	Free backup	Cleaner shares location manually

GPS Policy (Share With Team)

"We use GPS check-ins for arrival and departure only — not continuous tracking off the clock. This protects you when clients claim you weren't there, and protects clients when we confirm service completion."

Implementation

1. **Arrival check-in** — required within 5 minutes of scheduled start
2. **Departure check-out** — required before leaving property
3. **Flag exceptions** — no check-in after 15 min = auto-alert to manager
4. **Never use GPS punitively** for bathroom breaks or legitimate stops

Photo Documentation

Photos are your #1 quality control and dispute resolution tool.

Required Photos (Every Job)

When	What to Capture
Arrival	Front door or entry (proves you were there)
Issues found	Pre-existing damage, heavy soil, broken items
Completion	Kitchen, bathrooms, made beds, floors
Departure	Same angle as arrival (optional but powerful)

Photo Standards

- Well-lit, not blurry
- Upload to team chat or app within 30 minutes
- Never include client personal items identifiable in marketing
- Store for 90 days minimum (cloud folder by date/client)

When Photos Save You

- Client claims bathroom wasn't cleaned — you have timestamped proof
- Cleaner says they finished — photos show missed areas for coaching
- Damage dispute — arrival photo shows pre-existing condition

Use the [Photo Documentation Checklist](#) from Module 5.

Group Chats & Communication

Structure

Channel	Purpose	Who's In
Team Operations (Slack/WhatsApp/iMessage)	Daily updates, coverage, supply alerts	All active cleaners + you
Management Only	HR, firings, client complaints	You + lead cleaners
Client-facing	Never mix with team chat	Separate business line/app

Group Chat Rules

1. **Professional tone always** — this is a work record
2. **No client bashing** — discuss issues privately with manager
3. **Coverage requests** — post by 6 PM day before when possible
4. **Photos go in chat** — not DMs to owner only (transparency)
5. **Response time** — managers reply within 2 hours during business hours

Daily Check-In Template

📍 [Name] – Arrived [Client Last Name] [Time]

📍 [Name] – Completed [Client Last Name] [Time] – No issues

⚠️ [Name] – [Client] – Running 20 min late, notified client

What NOT to Do

- Don't let group chat replace the scheduling app
- Don't discuss pay disputes publicly in group chat
- Don't add clients to team channels

Uniforms & Professional Appearance

Minimum Standard

- Clean, solid-color shirt (company logo optional)
- Dark pants or jeans without holes
- Closed-toe shoes

- Hair tied back if long
- Minimal perfume (many clients have sensitivities)
- Company ID badge or branded shirt (recommended)

Branded Apparel Options

Item	Cost	Where to Order
Logo polo	\$15–\$25 each	Vistaprint, Custom Ink
Apron with logo	\$12–\$20	Amazon, local print shop
Name badge	\$5–\$10	Office supply

Policy Language

"Cleaners represent 100% Cleaner in every home. Appearance must be neat and professional. Company shirts are provided after 30 days. Lost shirts replaced at cost."

Call-Offs & Coverage Protocol

Call-Off Policy

Notice	Consequence
24+ hours	No penalty, help find coverage
Same day (before 7 AM)	Warning, document
No-show	Immediate suspension pending review

Call-Off Procedure (Cleaner)

1. Text **manager AND** group chat (not just a friend on the team)
2. Include: name, client affected, reason (brief), availability to help reschedule
3. Do not contact client to cancel unless manager assigns you to

Coverage Procedure (Manager)

1. Check backup cleaner list by zone
2. Offer bonus (\$20–\$50) for same-day coverage
3. Notify client **before** original appointment time

4. Document in scheduling app
5. Log call-off in performance tracker

Backup Cleaner System

Maintain a ranked list per geographic zone:

Zone	Primary	Backup 1	Backup 2
North			
South			
East			
West			

Performance Tracking

KPIs Per Cleaner (Track Monthly)

Metric	Target	How to Measure
On-time arrival	95%+	GPS / app check-in
Photo compliance	100%	Spot audit weekly
Client rating	4.8+ / 5	Post-job survey or text
Callback rate	< 5%	Re-cleans within 7 days
Call-off rate	< 2/month	Attendance log
Jobs completed	Per schedule	Scheduling app

Weekly Manager Review (15 min per cleaner)

- ☐ Review last week's photos (random 2 jobs)
- ☐ Check client feedback
- ☐ Note attendance issues
- ☐ Send one piece of positive feedback + one coaching tip

Performance Scorecard (Monthly)

Category	Weight	Score (1–5)	Weighted
Quality	30%		
Reliability	25%		
Communication	20%		
Speed/efficiency	15%		
Team attitude	10%		
Total	100%		

4.5+: Top performer — bonus eligible

3.5–4.4: Solid — standard coaching

Below 3.5: Performance plan (30 days to improve)

Scheduling Best Practices

Route by Geography

- Cluster jobs by city/zip to reduce drive time
- Max 4–5 jobs per cleaner per day (residential)
- Buffer 30 minutes between jobs for drive + overrun

Skill Matching

Job Type	Assign To
Regular recurring	Any trained cleaner
Deep clean	Experienced only (90+ days)
Move-out	Lead cleaner or paired team
Difficult client	Your best communicator

Avoid Burnout

- No more than 6 days/week regularly
- Rotate heavy deep cleans across team
- Give preferred clients as retention reward

Conflict Resolution

Cleaner vs. Client

1. Listen to both sides without assuming
2. Review photos and notes from job
3. Offer re-clean if legitimate miss (company cost)
4. Document in client file
5. Reassign if personality mismatch

Cleaner vs. Cleaner

1. Private conversation first
 2. Clarify roles (lead vs. helper on team jobs)
 3. Separate on paired jobs if needed
 4. Escalate to written warning if unprofessional
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Lead Cleaner Role

Promote your best performer to lead when you have 3+ cleaners.

Lead cleaner responsibilities:

- Train new hires on shadow days
- First call for coverage gaps in their zone
- Quality spot-checks on team jobs
- +\$10–\$15 per job or monthly stipend (\$200–\$400)

Lead cleaner does NOT:

- Hire/fire without your approval
 - Change pricing or make client promises
 - Access financial data
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Team Meeting Cadence

Meeting	Frequency	Duration	Agenda
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Huddle	Weekly (virtual OK)	15 min	Schedule, wins, one reminder
Training	Monthly	30 min	One SOP deep-dive
1-on-1	Quarterly	20 min	Performance, goals, concerns

Tools Stack Summary

Function	Recommended
Scheduling	Jobber, Housecall Pro, ZenMaid
Communication	WhatsApp, Slack, or Connecteam
GPS	Built into scheduling app
Photo storage	Google Drive folder per month
Performance	Simple spreadsheet or Notion

*Consistency beats intensity. Run these systems every week, not just when something breaks.
100% Cleaner / The Cleaning CEO Blueprint.*